

OE3C Planning Meeting 8

Date: 05 Feb 2026

Location: CRN 527/Online

Time: 11:03 AM – 12:03 PM

Attendees: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder, Kiyoko Gotanda, Reem Mahamoud, Sarah Hein, Nicholas Benton, Matthew Summerville, Cassia Hamilton, Harry Kumbhani, Wylan Clitheroe, Sowmya Movva, Lauren Nesbitt

Chairs: Lyllian Corbin, Alex Wilder

Minutes by: Lyllian Corbin

[Recap: OE3C Standing Meeting time February 5 | Meeting | Microsoft Teams](#)

Lyllian began the meeting at 11:03 AM.

Call to Order and Approval of Minutes

- Previous meeting minutes were approved

Workshops and Outings Update

- Update from Madelaine (Nick is speaking on Madelaine's behalf)
 - o Madelaine is currently in talks with Taylor from CCOVI
 - Will send updates when she gets a response
 - o Poll results for photo competition platform
 - Most people voted to use the PollUnit platform
 - 1 month subscription = \$36 USD
 - Any questions/objections should be sent by the end of next week (Feb 13th) otherwise, we shall proceed with this platform
 - Madelaine will work out the logistics
 - o Categories for photo competition
 - 3 Es (ecology, ethology, evolution)
 - Landscape
 - Close-up flora/plants
 - Fauna/wildlife/animals
 - Invertebrates/insects
 - Fungi + Lichen

- Fieldwork
 - We will have a People's Choice Award for the photo competition
 - Photos will also be shared via social media posts
 - *Appended from Madelaine's notes:*
 - Waiting to connect with Cindy at Hadiya'dagenhahs to plan Indigenous ecology workshop
 - Planning tours and tasting with Taylor at CCOVI – updated the schedule spreadsheet to include possible dates/times
 - Will plan the photo competition on PollUnit if there are no objections
 - Next steps
 - Will send expense report form and connect with Matt regarding social media posts
 - Will work on setting up PollUnit platform and planning logistics of competition
 - Madelaine and subcommittee will start brainstorming prize packs
- Workshops update with Nick
 - Got room assignments for workshops and finalised workshops in the schedule
 - Photography workshop led by Kiyoko will be in Thistle
 - Kiyoko: booked room Thistle 246 for April 30th, 9am-5pm
 - Computer science workshop will be held in South block (Scotiabank Hall)
 - Met with Rasa and Sowmya
 - Topic of workshop is “evolutionary computation”
 - Background of evolutionary algorithms
 - Run on Google co-lab, so everyone can bring their own PCs
 - Kiyoko: booked room SBH217 for April 30th, 9am-5pm
 - Scavenger hunt will take place in Mac Chown (room MC F237 is booked for this)
 - Scavenger hunt will happen during hike
 - First Nations ecology workshop will take place in Pond Inlet
- Wylan's update on the guided hikes
 - Re-wilding theme and how we live within nature
 - Working on theme writing and planning
 - Also planning the mindfulness hike
 - Will be defining routes for hikes soon

Keynote Update (with Harry)

- Maydianne can no longer make it to do a keynote talk
 - o She recently became a Dean at York
 - o Alternative ethology speaker: Sarah from UBC or Quinn from Guelph
 - Harry wants to know budget-wise if it's feasible to have someone from out west come to Brock
 - Kiyoko confirmed we have \$850 of funds left for 2 plenary speakers
 - o Saving \$165 for Nancy
 - o Not sure if it's feasible to have two speakers from UBC
- Ecology speaker is still unknown – Harry has not heard back from Jesse yet
 - o Next potential speaker is Andrea from UBC or Katherine Yagi
- Kiyoko confirmed that Nancy Chen's hotel has been booked
 - o Figuring out how to get Nancy from Toronto to Brock

Catering Discussion/Notes (with Lyllian and Alex)

- Lunch vouchers
 - o Alex asked how we want to distribute the lunch vouchers
 - Stuffed into nametags? Use a card or QR code?
 - Kiyoko mentioned this will depend on DeCew
 - o Lyllian mentioned that currently Brock Dining will only reimburse unused vouchers if we collect and return the vouchers to the Brock Dining office
 - Alex suggested that we look into this and discuss alternative options because it will be impossible to collect every unused voucher after distributing them to attendees
 - o Lunch vouchers are already included in the registration costs – Reem will work on excluding the extra lunch voucher fees from the website
- Lyllian gave a brief overview of potential costs for a coffee break, based on a past invoice from FMS GRaD 2025
 - o E.g., 3 large urns of coffee, 2 sets of tea, 4 large urns of infused water, and 16 trays of snack platters (4 trays each of: veggies, fruits, cheese+crackers, and cookies+brownies) will cost ~\$1700

Registration Update (with Reem)

- Breakfast fees will be optional on the registration page
 - o Current cost is \$15 + tax

- All costs need to include taxes instead of showing the taxes separately in brackets
- Reem is still waiting to hear from Lucas to help with adjustments and questions
- Banquet costs will need to be updated from \$50 to \$90
 - *Unless this is subject to change?*

Social Media and Website Updates

- Social media update with Matthew
 - Matthew is following the suggested post schedule for social media
 - Questions
 - Registration teaser – when does registration open?
 - Timing is TBD because Reem is waiting on Lucas to respond
 - Webinar post – are we pursuing that option?
 - We are skipping this option for now
 - Speaker spotlight post?
 - We can show a post on Nancy Chen as our Evolution keynote speaker
 - Harry will upload her photo and summary to Teams for Matthew to use
- Website update with Alex and Sarah
 - Sarah made a schedule to post on the website page
 - Edits to be made:
 - Mindfulness hike needs to be included on the Saturday
 - Optional lunch needs to be included on the Thursday
 - Alex suggested we could provide DeCew vouchers
 - Kiyoko asked for the photography workshop to happen after 9 am (preferably around 10 am)
 - Nick confirmed that the room code should be SBH217 for one of the workshops

Banquet Update (With Cassia and Alex)

- Banquet menu will include a main, dessert, pasta, and salad
 - Tickets will be ~\$90 for these options
 - Mains will include chicken, fish, and red meat options
 - We will have a cash bar which will cost ~\$400
- Entertainment

- Alex's brother has mini golf and can set up music
 - ~\$1700 for the whole day with staff and the entire set up
- Photo booth
- Seed paper stamped with OE3C logo (wildflower seeds from Stokes)
- Décor ideas – following the conference theme
 - Vines
 - Lauren asked if people could bring displays from their labs
 - We like this idea
 - Wylan wants to do something similar for the scavenger hunt as well
- Dress code will be business casual encouraged
 - Semi formal is optional
- Alex recapping the bar options
 - We could do a cash bar or bring our own wine bottles (from local wineries) and pay a corkage fee
 - Fee covers the bartender opening and serving the wine for us serve
 - We could sell a drink access ticket so people can access the bar this way
 - We can also think about where to place the bar in Market
 - Should we have the bar set up in a separate area or in the same area as the banquet? (to respect people that do not drink alcohol)

Merch Update (with Lauren)

- T-shirts
 - Has estimated pricing for Gildan shirts, but she was only given costs for the regular crew neck shirts
 - Will need to check again for costs to get V-neck shirts
 - We also agreed on having larger logo on the front of the shirt instead of a crest
 - Lauren will confirm the shirt production time, but it shouldn't take long
 - We could put the picture of the t-shirt on the registration page and people can start buying
 - Committee members will get one shirt and members can pay for extra shirts if needed
- Other merch
 - Making stickers at MakerSpace?
- Swag in tote bags
 - Sticker
 - Notebooks with "OE3C 2026" stamped on the front

- Conference program
- Lunch vouchers
- Alex will do a post-meeting form for us to list further ideas

Schedule Update

- Current schedule is probably good to put on the website
 - Feedback should be on Sarah's word document on Teams by Wednesday next week

Meeting adjourned at 12:03 PM.